



Alaska Airlines

Change Management Process Guide

Version No. 1.3





Table of Contents

1.0	Introduction	2
1.1	Purpose	2
1.2	Scope	2
2.0	Alaska Change Management Process	3
2.1	CAB (Change Advisory Board) Process	3
2.2	Types of Changes	3
2.2.1	Normal Change	3
2.2.2	Emergency Change	4
2.2.3	Standard Change	5
2.2.4	Informational Change	6
2.3	Change Request Creation	7
2.4	Change Freeze Information	7
2.5	Change Management Team Roles and Responsibilities	8



1.0 Introduction

This document describes the Procedure for Change Management within ITIS practice. The goal of the Change Management process is to ensure that standardized methods and procedures are used for efficient and prompt handling of all Changes in order to minimize the impact of Change-related Incidents upon service quality, and consequently to improve the day-to-day operations of the organization.

1.1 Purpose

The process of Change Management controls the lifecycle of all changes with minimal disruption to IT services. Change management ensure that all technical and logistical issues regarding the change have been reviewed adequately. Change Management is the process of end-to-end handling of all Change Requests.

1.2 Scope

Change Management Process policies provide guidance to the Change Management Analyst for process administration. Policies also provide standards for the technical staff on the documentation and implementation of change records. Change records must be created for ALL changes performed in the production environment.

2.0 Alaska Change Management Process

- Change records must be created for ALL changes performed in the production environment.
- The Change record should include enough information to provide a thorough view of the impact to the production environment and provide sufficient instructions so that a knowledgeable team member could perform the change, if needed.
- All changes must have a documented risk assessment.
- Changes are expected to be implemented during customer defined and approved change or maintenance window.

2.1 CAB (Change Advisory Board) Process

- The CAB meeting occurs every week on Thursday at 02:00 PM to 03:00 PM PST
- For all the Medium/High risk, Emergency and Standard changes requestor needs approval from CAB (Change Advisory Board). A Minimum of 2 CAB member approvals are required for all Medium and High-Risk changes before they can be implemented.
- All the Normal (High/Medium risk) and Standard changes should be created, and peer reviewed before the cutoff period on Monday 5:00 PM PST to be discussed in CAB meeting
- Low risk changes do not require CAB approval, however if the change owner wants to provide additional visibility to their change they may 'Volunteer' their change to CAB. This is done by checking the "**Volunteer to CAB**" option in the Change Request and then present it during the CAB meeting.
- If there is any urgency to implement any High/Medium risk changes prior to the CAB meeting, change requestor should get an offline CAB approval from the CAB members by sending an email to CABMembers@alaskaair.onmicrosoft.com with the explanation of CR. Change owners should use the below offline template with the CR details for requesting offline CAB approval:



Requesting Offline
CAB Approval for - CF

2.2 Types of Changes

- Change request types in Alaska includes Low Risk, Medium/High Risk, Emergency, Standard and Informational Changes.
- All the implemented changes are expected to be closed within 3 business days of implementation.

2.2.1 Normal Change:

All changes performed in the production should have a normal CR created and follow the approval

- Low Risk - Requires approval from a Peer reviewer
- Medium & High Risk – Requires Peer approval and approval by the Change Advisory Board (CAB).

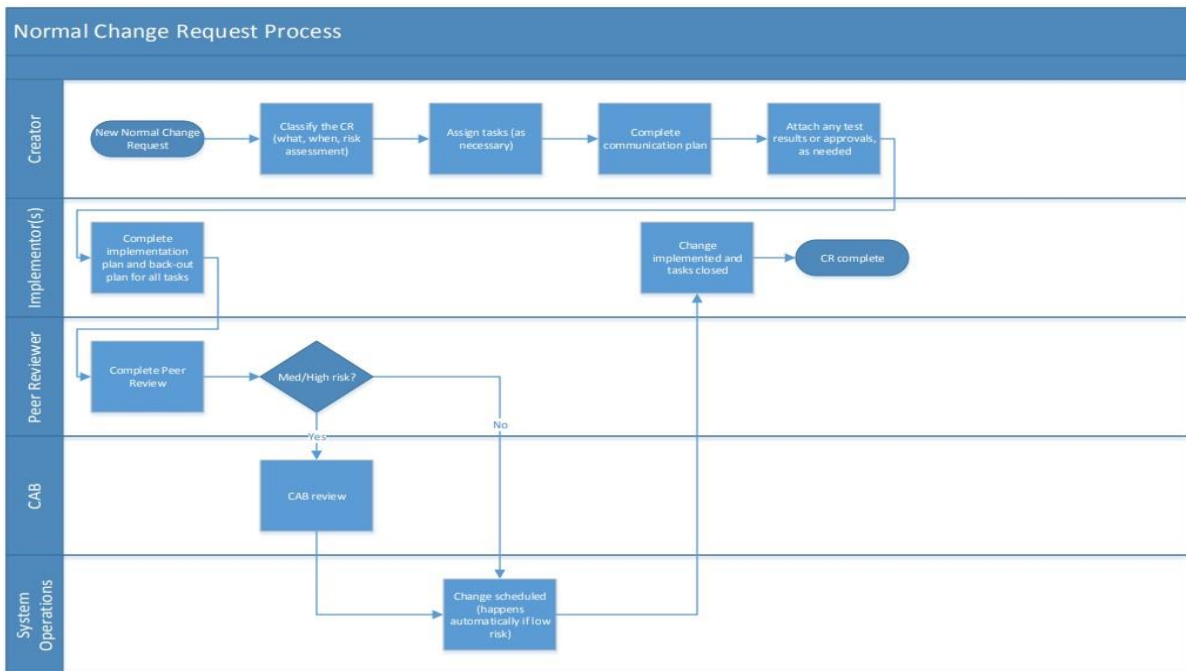
➤ High and Medium CR Approval Procedure:

1. Login To Cherwell with own Credential.
2. Click on Normal Change to create CR with All required field with proper priority.

3. Cherwell will trigger an Email to the peer approver or team for the peer review approval.
4. Once peer review is approved, change owner will push the CR to Pending CAB for CAB approval.
5. After getting approval from CAB members, CR will move to Implementing state.

➤ **Low CR Approval Procedure:**

1. Login to Cherwell with own Credential
2. Click on Normal Change to create CR with all required field with proper priority.
3. Cherwell will trigger an Email to the peer approver or team for the peer review approval.
4. Once peer review is approved, CR will stand as Implement Stage.



2.2.2 Emergency Change:

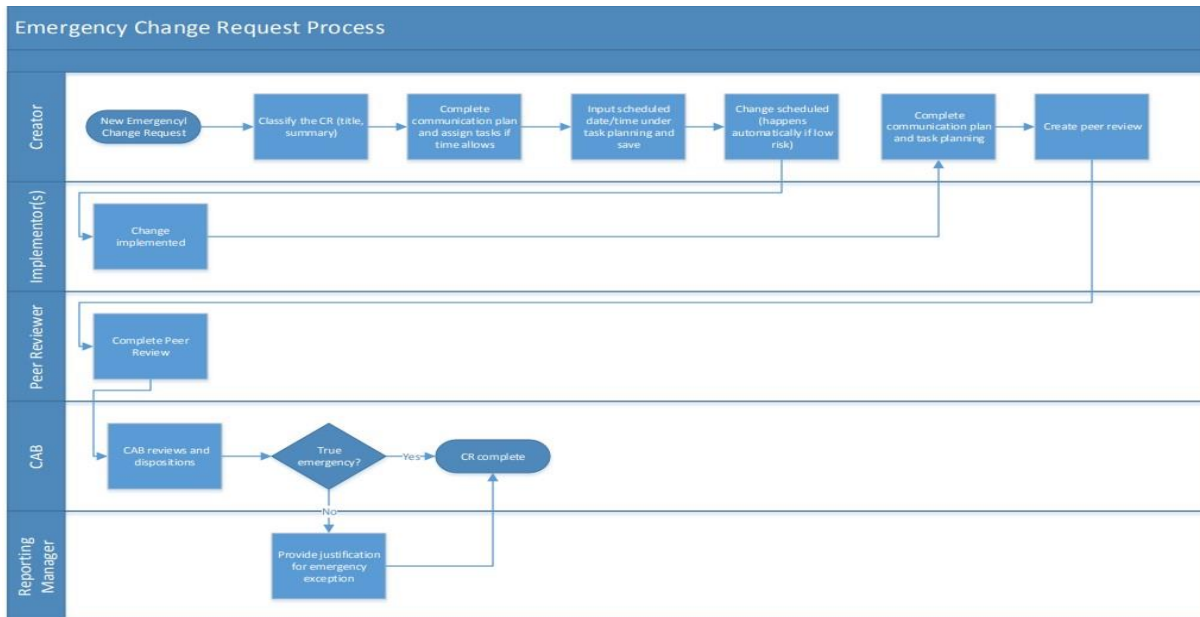
Anytime you need to perform unscheduled work to the production environment as the result of an incident then an emergency change should be created.

- All the Emergency changes require an associated Incident attached to the CR
- Requires approval from a Peer
- Requires post approval by the Change Advisory Board (CAB). Emergency changes must be presented in the CAB meeting within 7 days of its implementation.

➤ **Emergency CR Approval Procedure:**

1. Login to Cherwell with own Credential
2. Click on Emergency Change to create CR with all required field with proper priority
3. Emergency changes must include a valid incident associated to the change and must be review/approved by the CAB in a CAB meeting.

4. Emergency changes must be presented in the CAB meeting within 7 days of its implementation.
5. Emergency changes can be CAB approved post implementation.



2.2.3 Standard Change:

Change preapproved by Change Advisory Board, relatively common, performed according to a pre-established procedure. Change must be Low risk and completed without errors 3 times in a row or authorized as part of the CI/CD pipeline.

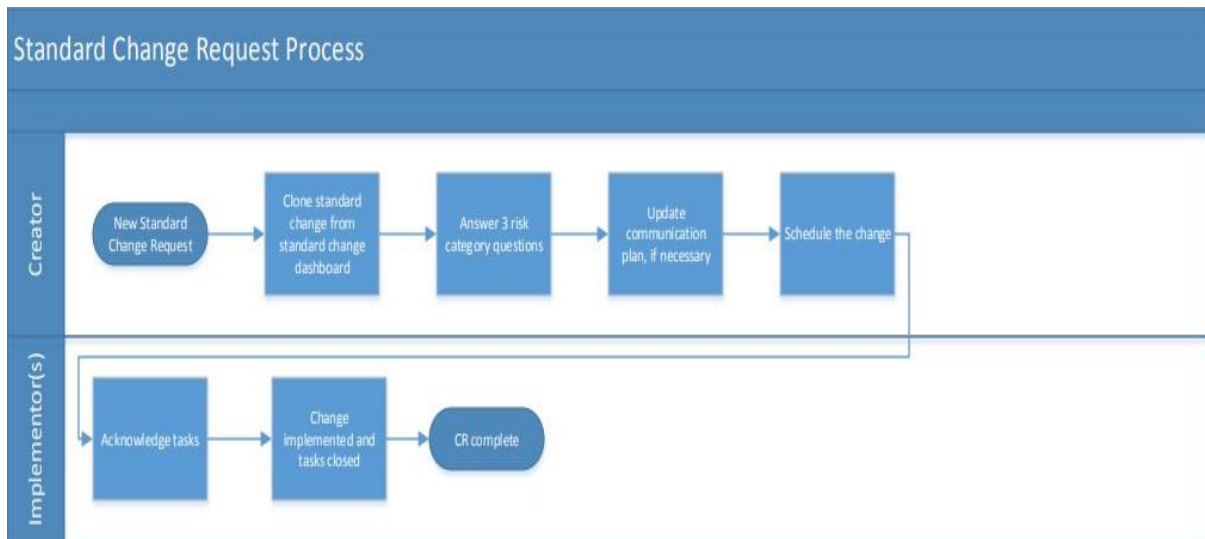
➤ Standard CR Approval Procedure:

1. All changes that are nominated to become a Standard Change must be a low risk change and must be closed.
2. The Standard Change 'Supporting Info' document must be completed and attached to the CR for CAB review.



StandardCR-SupportingInfo document.docx

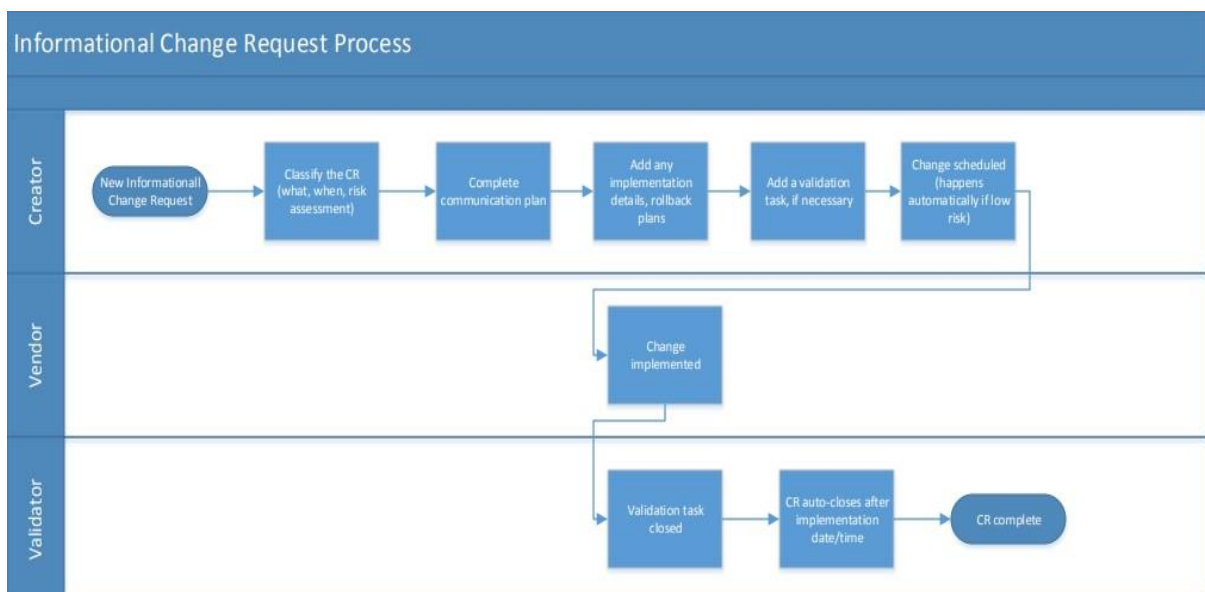
3. Standard Changes are valid for one year and then must be re-nominated as a standard change. When the change has been re-nominated, it will appear in the CAB dashboard.
4. Any Standard Change which has been re-nominated more than once will not show up in the CAB dashboard. (This is a flaw in Cherwell) In this case the change owner may email change coordinator prior to the CAB meeting letting them know that they have a Standard Change Request to be reviewed at the meeting or add a request to review the change in the meeting chat.



2.2.4 Informational Change:

Informational CR are created if you need to document work being done by a Vendor or third party that has potential to impact the production Airgroup environment.

Examples: Power Outages, known vendor changes, Circuit outages.





2.3 Change Request Creation

Change request should be created in Cherwell for all production changes. Please refer to the attached file



Cherwell%20-%20Change%20Request_training.pptx

➤ Change Record Style Guide

A guide to help change request owners to write effective and consistent change record titles and descriptions. Please refer to the attached file



Change Record Style Guide (1).docx

2.4 Change Freeze Information

There are two types of change freeze as per Alaska change management process.

➤ Soft Change Freeze

- There is a weekly Soft Freeze on each weekend. This freeze begins on Friday morning at 12:00 AM PST and runs through 11:59 PM PST on Sunday night.
- Soft change freezes are extended if there is a holiday during the week. The additional freeze dates are determined by the day on which the holiday falls.
- All Changes implemented during a Soft Freeze period must have an additional Director's approval. This is created on the Home 'New' panel when the change request is created.
- Emergency Changes do not require any additional approvals during the Soft Freeze period.

➤ Hard Change Freeze

- The Hard Change Freeze dates are determined by upper management and the Change Freeze calendar in Cherwell updated accordingly.
- A Hard Change Freeze schedule announcement is prepared by the Change Management team. This will be shared with ITS Communications for distribution. ITS Communication will then send out this announcement to all the ITS & E-Commerce groups with the Hard Freeze schedule.
- All changes that are implemented during a Hard Change Freeze are required to have additional upper management approvals. These are: Director approval, two approvals from either a Managing Director or the Vice President of ITS, and CAB approval. These additional upper management approvals may be in the form of an email which is then attached to the change request.
- Standard changes cannot be implemented during a hard freeze using a pipeline. All standard changes can be cloned from the parent change and implemented as a Normal Change and follow the hard freeze approval process.

Note: Any change that is implemented without following the above rules is considered as a violation of Alaska's Change Management Standards and is subject to audit.



2.5 Change Management Team Roles and Responsibilities

- **Daily change audit** - For all the changes which are opened on the same day before 11 AM PST to make sure all the changes are as per documentation standards (Title, description, implementation/ backout/ verification plans)
- **Change conflict report** - Every Monday before 10 AM PST, Cognizant change management team should share the previous week change review summary and number of changes that were in conflict and status of those changes.
- **Change closure follow-ups** - As per the Alaska Change management process, all the changes should be closed in the system within 3 days (72 hours) of the planned end time. Cognizant Change management team will follow up those changes on daily basis and share the weekly report to the Alaska management before 1 PM on every Friday.
- **Hosting CAB meeting** – Cognizant Change management team is responsible for hosting weekly CAB (Change Advisory Board) meeting which happens on every week Thursday.
- Assisting change owners in updating Standard support document for the Nominated Standard changes.
- Updating Change Freeze Calendar in Cherwell

Date	Version	Status	Updated by	Summary of Changes
06 th Jun 2024	1.0	Initial Version	CM Team	Initial Copy
28 th Feb 2025	1.2	Next Updated	Deepthi/Sai	Updated the document.
08 th Dec 2025	1.3	Updated	Sai/Deepthi	Updated with new process change

Date	Reviewed By	Summary of Review
06 th Jun 2024	Yogesh Shanmugam	Document review
28 th Feb 2025	Jennifer Margaret	Document Review
08 th Dec 2025	Jennifer Margaret	Document Review

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